Léa went to Maria's side, lifting her back so she could sit up and use her upper body to give her more power.

"*Arhhh*," Maria shouted. Léa pulled her hair back away from her face.

"The baby's crowning," Josef said, leaning forward. "Push, Maria, push."

A few pushes later, and a dark-haired girl slid out. Josef cut the umbilical cord, placed her on the scale, then wrapped her in a blanket before putting her in Maria's arms.

"Thank you," Maria said, guiding the baby to her breast.

"You did all the hard work." Josef smiled. "Get her to feed well tonight so she can put on weight."

Léa noted how tiny the baby appeared. "What's her name?"

"*Ewa*," Maria said, "it means Eve."

"That's beautiful." Léa leaned down and kissed Ewa on the crown. "For a beautiful girl."

Léa cleaned up the towels and mopped the floor. Two women were scheduled to come later tonight to clean the sick bay, but she didn't want to leave the afterbirth mess on the floor or bed, and Josef had too much to do to tend to it. When she finished, she found him in the office, writing notes for the reports.

"It all happened so quickly," she said. "Her labor couldn't have taken more than two hours. I thought labor was a twelve- or eighteen-hour event."

"Maria had a compressed labor."

"What's that?"

"It can happen when a baby has a low birth weight. Small babies move through the birth canal more quickly. When I weighed the baby, she was at just under two kilos."

"What would a baby normally weigh?"

"Three kilos." He wiped his forehead. "Can you give Maria an ampoule of Betabion, please? She's going to need to pass the Vitamin D on to the baby in her milk." He sighed. "I hate seeing them so vulnerable."

Léa nodded and made her way to the medicine cabinet. Betabion was one of the items she'd brought back from Berlin. After returning from the capital, she'd helped Josef arrange everything he'd requested, asking him about each one in the process. He required four boxes of Betabion. "It's vitamin B or thiamine," he explained. "Those suffering from malnutrition